A Short Tour of VectorPDF

Five minutes with what sets it apart. All of it works on your own PDFs.

1 Follow a reference and stay on your page

Hold **Command** and move the pointer over each blue reference. Its target appears where you are, and disappears when you let go.

- An equation: the conversion in Equation (1).
- A figure: the plan in Figure 1.
- A table: the scales in Table 1.
- A section: the start of Section 4.
- A citation: the PDF standard, [1].

Hold Command and click Figure 1 to open it in a window of its own, beside this one.

2 Search for what the page really says

Press **Command-F** and search for *end to end*. Smart Search finds end-to-end and the end to end that breaks across this line too. Results appear in the sidebar as they're found.

3 Keep your place

Select this sentence and press **Command-B** to save it as an anchor. Open the Anchors tab in the sidebar and click the anchor to come straight back, from anywhere in this document or in another tab.

Then select some text and press **Shift-Command-H** to highlight it, or press **Shift-Command-A** to show the Markup toolbar. This is your own copy of the tour, so mark it up however you like.

When you're ready, press **Command-O** and open a document of your own.

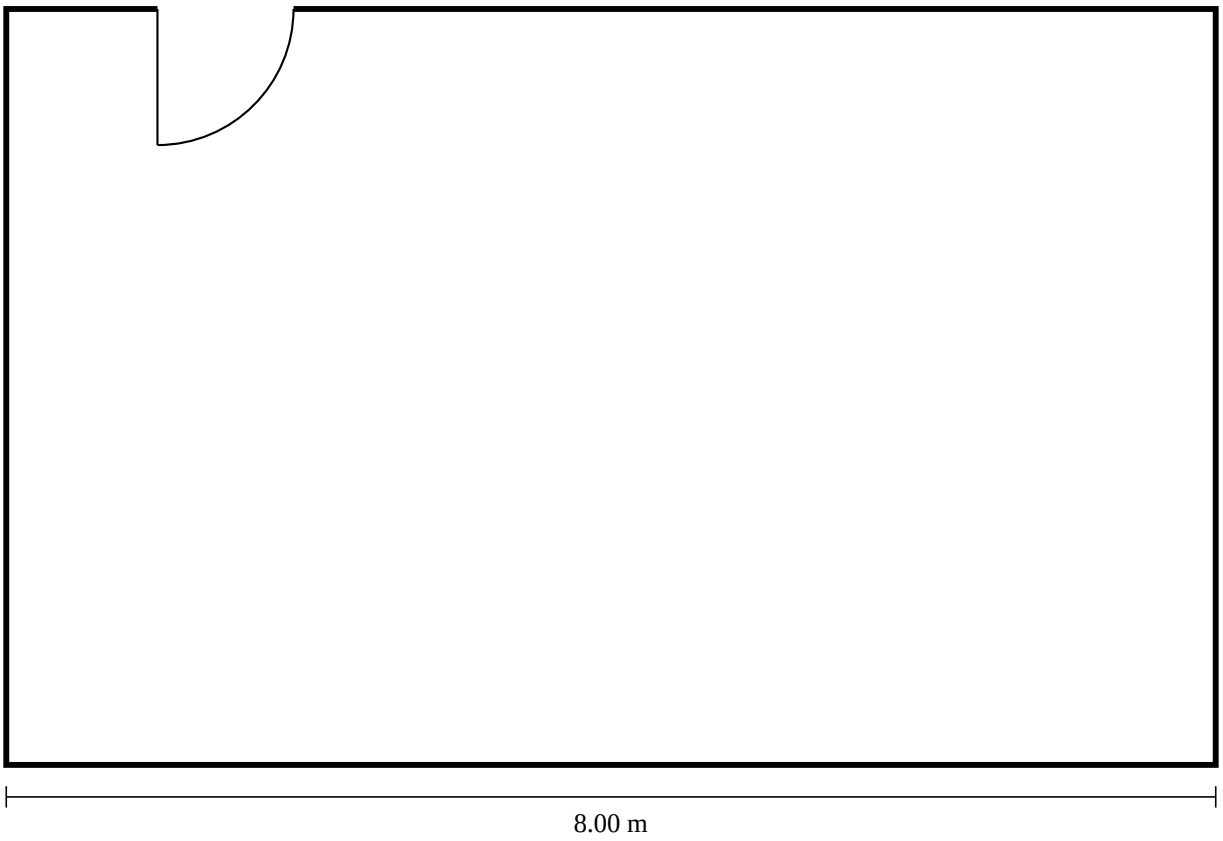
4 Measuring a drawing

The rest of this document is a small worked example, there to give the references on the first page somewhere to go. A drawing's scale relates a length on the page to the real length, as in Equation (1).

$$L = d \times n \tag{1}$$

Here L is the real length, d is the length measured on the drawing, and n is the scale's denominator. At 1:50, a line 160 mm long on the page is 8 m long in the building.

Figure 1. A room drawn at 1:50



This plan is drawn to scale. To try it, show the Measurement toolbar, calibrate from the 8.00 m dimension, and measure the room's area.

5 Common scales

Table 1 lists scales in common use, with what 10 mm on the page represents. PDF stores this as a viewport with a measure dictionary [1], so other PDF apps can read a scale that's saved in the file.

Table 1. Common drawing scales

Scale	10 mm on the page	Typical use
1:5	50 mm	Construction details
1:20	200 mm	Sections and elevations
1:50	500 mm	Floor plans
1:100	1 m	Building plans
1:500	5 m	Site plans

References

[1] ISO 32000-2:2020, *Document management — Portable document format — Part 2: PDF 2.0*. International Organization for Standardization.